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The embryonic cell lineage of the nematode Caenorhabditis elegans

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Published Developmental Biology (1983)

Paper Link https://doi.org/10.1016/0012-1606(83)90201-4

Domain DOM_BIO

Abstract

The embryonic cell lineage of Caenorhabditis elegans has been traced from zygote to newly hatched larva by continuous direct observation of living individuals with differential interference contrast microscopy. The lineage is largely invariant between individuals, producing 671 cells of which 113 undergo programmed cell death. Tracking and cataloguing complex hierarchical descent across multiple developmental stages requires recording branching genealogies, where repeated ancestral developmental sequences present substantial data representation and redundancy challenges.

Abstract quoted from J. E. Sulston et al., Developmental Biology (1983).

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